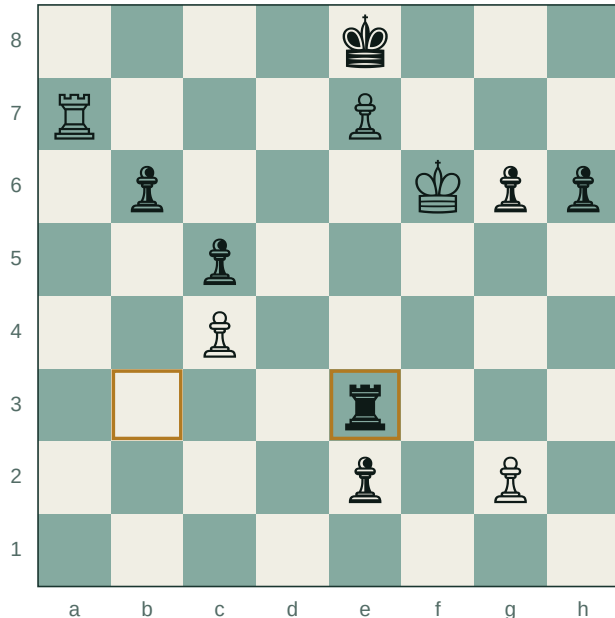


Deflection tactics: White, move 38

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 37...Re3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Ra8+ Kd7 39. Rd8+ Kc7 40. e8=Q Rxe8 41. Rxe8

38.Ra8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38...Kd7**.

39.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39...Kc7**.

40.e8=Q The pawn moves from e7 to e8. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **40...Rxe8**.

41.Rxe8 The rook captures the rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on e3. Check for tactical protection.